

DESCRIPTIVE WRITING GUIDE

ZOOM-IN METHOD

A common technique in descriptive writing is to start with the background. Set the scene before zoom-in and panning to different parts of a setting.



(Drop: Establish the scene broadly)

The city street pulsed with life—a river of honking taxis, flickering neon signs, and hurried footsteps echoing off glass skyscrapers. Pedestrians swarmed like ants, their faces obscured by umbrellas and phone screens, all moving in chaotic unison under the setting afternoon sun.

(Shift: Narrow focus to the man.)

Amidst the tide, one figure stood apart. A middle-aged man in a red t-shirt, his stood up straight as he monitored the busy intersection below the sky train. He quietly stood at the curb, inspecting the turbulent traffic and myraid of lights from street signs and buildings.

(Zoom: Close-up details.)

His knuckles, white around the handle, betrayed a tremor. A coffee stain streaked down his left sleeve—old, but he'd clearly tried to scrub it, the fabric fraying from effort. His shoes, once polished, were scuffed at the toes, the left heel slightly worn. When the crosswalk signal blinked green, he lurched forward, eyes darting—not at the traffic, but at the faces around him. A flicker of recognition? Fear? His lower lip twitched, chewing words he never spoke.

(Link: Connect details to meaning.)

Every detail whispered exhaustion. The briefcase, too heavy with papers or regrets; the stain, a relic of rushed mornings; the shoes, marching toward another joyless destination. He moved mechanically, yet his eyes—wide, almost startled—hinted at something raw beneath the weariness. Was he late? Lost? Or simply tired of crossing the same street, day after day?

Drop

Shift

Zoom

Link

STORY MOUNTAIN

Rising Action

Building up to the main problem / obstacle / conflict in the story

Climax

The peak of the story, the fate of characters are decided and the story is short / fast / action-packed

Initial Incident

The start of story conflict and complication, beginning a plot point

Falling Action

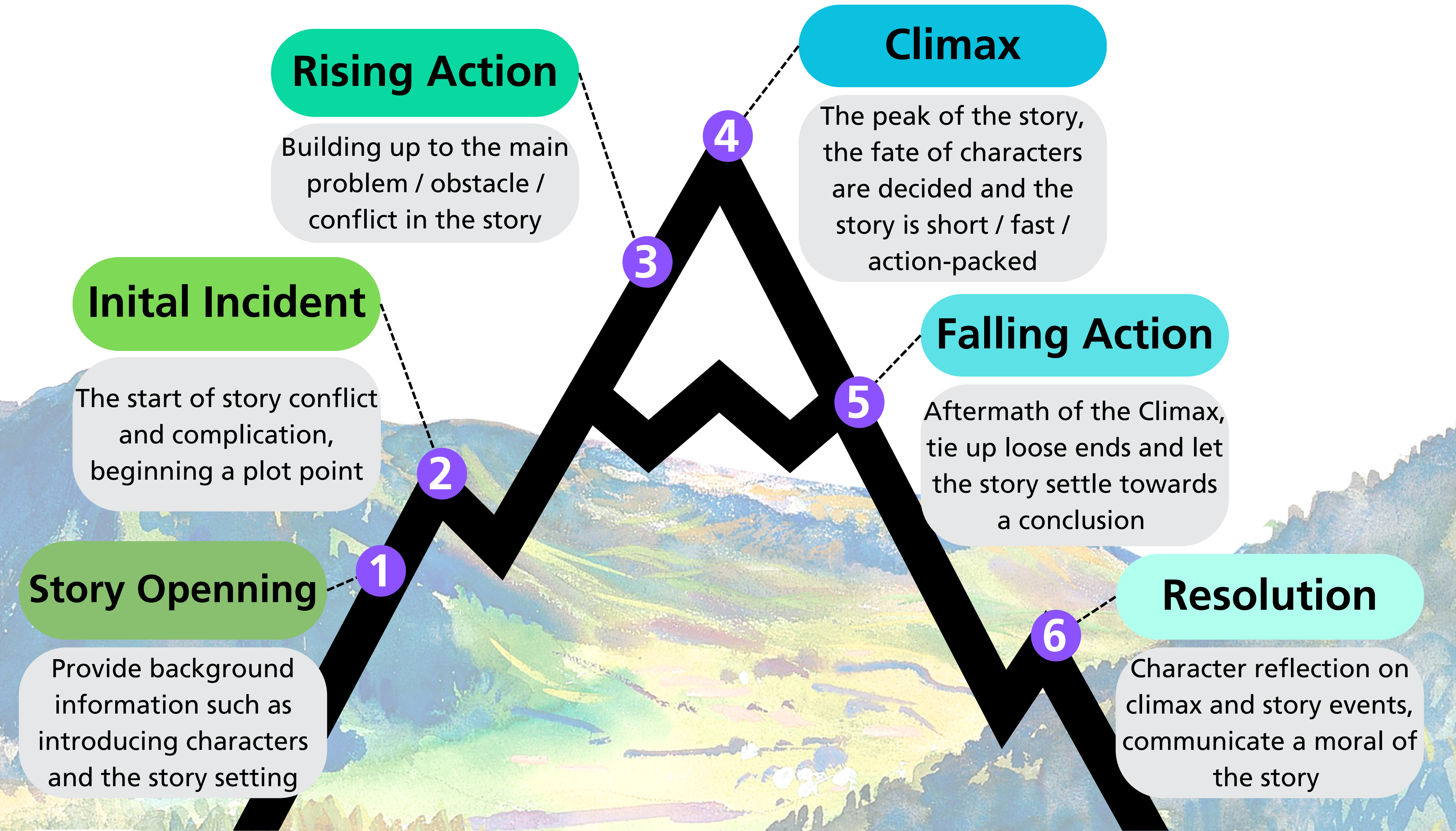
Aftermath of the Climax, tie up loose ends and let the story settle towards a conclusion

Story Opening

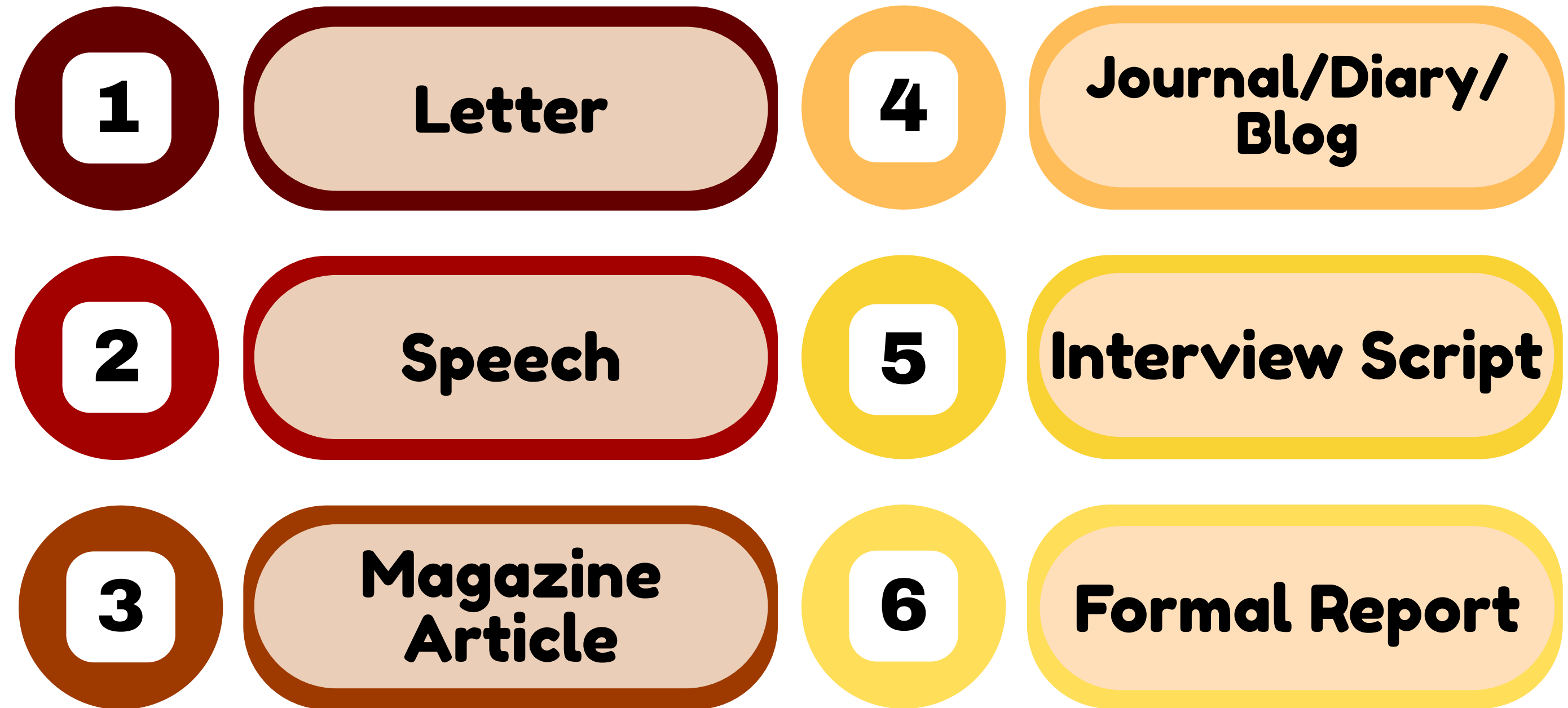
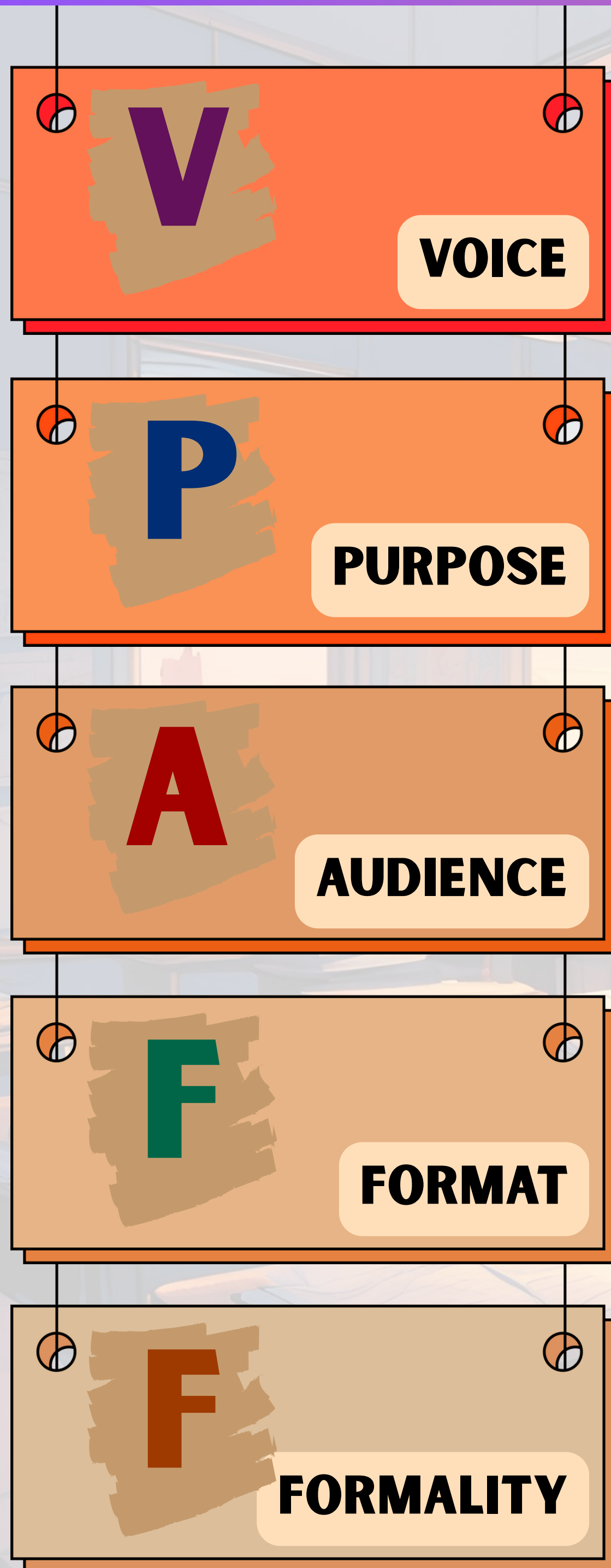
Provide background information such as introducing characters and the story setting

Resolution

Character reflection on climax and story events, communicate a moral of the story



READING AND WRITING GUIDE



VOICE

Local Journalist

PURPOSE

Need to better
safeguard the local area

AUDIENCE

Local residents

FORMAT

Magazine Article

FORMALITY

Formal / Persuasive Tone

EXAMPLE OF VPAFF IDENTIFICATION

Imagine you are a local journalist. Recent events have prompted you to write a magazine article about the need to better safeguard the area.

Write the magazine article.

In your article you should explain:

- the attractions of the local area and why people visit
- the problems affecting the area and the likely impact if things do not improve
- what Tom Michell did and why, and the result of his actions.

Base your article on what you have read in **Text C**, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin your article with a suitable headline.

Write about 250 to 350 words.